

The Starlight Archives • Story & Setting

READ THIS FIRST • EVIDENCE TABLE SETUP

WELCOME TO THE STARLIGHT ARCHIVES

Tonight, you have gathered for an exclusive after-hours meeting of the *Starlight Circle*—a secret society of writers, scholars, archivists, and insiders who hold special clearance inside the Starlight Archives. At 12:00 AM, the archives' most restricted vault was scheduled to open to reveal Catalog Item RB-1147: The Starlight Ledger.

THE LEAD-UP TO TONIGHT: Over the past week, the Curator (John) audited the archives' restricted movement logs and security archives. He discovered serious irregularities: unlogged entries into restricted areas, unauthorized access, defaced artifacts, and an embarrassing historical family scandal. John privately confronted multiple members, warning that his audit was complete and that every secret would be exposed during tonight's 12:00 AM presentation.

THE INCIDENT: Moments after guests gathered in the Main Reception Hall, the Curator entered clutching a coat sleeve tear and holding his arm in pain. Seconds later, in full view of everyone through the gallery archway, he reached out toward Display Case RB-1147, touched its brass lock handle, and dramatically collapsed to the floor—dead.

VICTIM PROFILE: JOHN (THE CURATOR)

Title / Role: Chief Curator, The Starlight Archives | **Status:** Deceased (Collapsed at Gallery Archway)

Known Evidence Found On / Near The Victim:

- **On His Person:** A minor coat sleeve tear and small surface scratch on his left forearm (*Preliminary findings: sustained during an argument earlier today*).
- **On His Desk:** A ceramic tea cup with saucer smelling of tea and concentrated bitter almond infusion.
- **At His Desk Safe:** A confidential handwritten note left for the Starlight Circle, cryptically noting that Item RB-1147 was tampered with before midnight.

Evidence Item 1: Access Log Terminal

Record

ROUND 1 DROP • CENTRAL ACCESS CONTROL LOG

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STARLIGHT ARCHIVES CENTRAL ACCESS CONTROL – AUTOMATED LOG

DATE: OCTOBER 24 | TIME WINDOW: 23:30 – 23:59

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[23:30:12] MAIN ENTRANCE: C. Claire (Order Keeper) – CARD KEY #002 [LOGGED]

[23:32:45] MAIN ENTRANCE: S. Sarah (Nocturnal Photographer) – GUEST PASS [LOGGED]

[23:35:00] GUEST CHECK-IN OPENED: Front Desk Console Active (Georgia/Charlotte)

[23:40:15] MAIN ENTRANCE: General Guest Arrivals Check-In Active [LOGGED]

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[23:42:00] SYSTEM ALERT: Rare Books Gallery Main Doors – **LOCKED / LOCKED**

[23:44:18] SECURITY SENSOR #04 (Gallery Courtyard Window Sill):

>>> **UNLOGGED MECHANICAL UNLATCH DETECTED <<<**

>>> **DURATION: 00:02:15 | ENTRY TYPE: PHYSICAL MASTER KEY <<<**

[23:46:33] SECURITY SENSOR #04 (Gallery Courtyard Window Sill):

>>> **LATCH SECURED / CLOSED <<<**

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[23:50:00] GALLERY ARCHWAY: J. John (Curator) – MANUAL KEY ACCESS [LOGGED]

[23:51:10] CRITICAL ALERT: Motion Sensor Gallery Case RB-1147 Interrupted

[23:51:15] **OCCUPANT COLLAPSE DETECTED – RARE BOOKS GALLERY ARCHWAY**

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 **Forensics Note for Sleuths:** Electronic readers only track door card swipes. Opening the courtyard window with a physical mechanical master key bypassed the main entrance card readers entirely! Notice the unlogged window unlatch at **23:44:18!**

Evidence Items 2 & 3: Incident Dossier & Audit

Notes

ROUND 1 DROP • SCENE

FINDINGS

CONFIDENTIAL CASE FILE #2026-1024

Victim: John (The Curator) | **Incident Time:** 23:51:15 HRS | **Location:** Rare Books Gallery Archway

Scene Observations: The victim entered clutching a visible tear on his left coat sleeve and holding his forearm. He stepped to the gallery archway, touched the brass lock of Case RB-1147, and suffered immediate collapse.

Three Competing Investigation Leads Identified at Scene:

1. **TRACK A (Physical Trauma):** Coat sleeve fabric tear and surface forearm scratch. Discarded craft blade recovered from hallway trash.
2. **TRACK B (Ingested Poison):** One (1) full ceramic tea cup on desk smelling strongly of bitter almond and herbal infusion.
3. **TRACK C (Contact Surface Poison):** Immediate collapse occurred upon physical contact with Case RB-1147's brass lock handle.

 CURATOR'S HANDWRITTEN AUDIT NOTES (OCTOBER 24)

"For seven days, I have quietly cross-referenced the physical preservation registers against the digital terminal logs. The discrepancies are undeniable. Someone inside the Starlight Circle has been abusing master access clearance to enter the restricted vault without leaving an official digital record. A sealed historical archive dossier has been tampered with to conceal an embarrassing, fraudulent family secret from 1926 that would strip a prominent member of their hereditary title... I will read the unlogged access breach out loud and revoke this individual's keys permanently at 12:00 AM."

— J. Curator

Evidence Item 4: Key Clearance

Register

ROUND 1 DROP • ADMINISTRATIVE SECURITY LOGS

STARLIGHT ARCHIVES — MASTER KEY & CLEARANCE LEVEL REGISTER

Role Title & Name	Key Clearance Type	Courtyard Window Access?	Vault Case RB-1147 Clearance?	Chemical Kit Access?
Keeper of Keys (Raelin)	Master Brass Key Ring (#000)	YES (Master Physical Clearance)	YES (Official Conservator)	YES (Full Kit — Jars A–E; CATCH Certified)
Rare Book Specialist (Charlotte)	Holding Area Keycard (#005)	NO	NO (Holding Area Only)	YES (Full Kit — Jars A–E; CATCH Certified)
Order Keeper (Claire)	Administrative Card (#002)	NO (Doors Only)	NO	NO
Puzzle Tinker (Ellie)	Workbench Pass (#008)	NO	NO	NO
Aesthetic Curator (Lucy)	Lighting Key (#011)	NO	NO	NO
All Other Guests / Members	Public Reading Pass	NO	NO	NO

 **Critical Deductive Insight:** Notice that only **Master Key #000** has the mechanical capability to physically unlatch the courtyard window. Standard electronic keycards (#002, #005, #008, #011) only operate digital door readers!

Evidence Item 9: Forensic Toxicology Report

ROUND 3 DROP • REGIONAL FORENSIC CRIME LAB

CRIME LAB BIOCHEMICAL ANALYSIS • STATUS: COMPLETED

CASE REF: STARLIGHT ARCHIVES INCIDENT | LAB FILE: #TOX-2026-881

1. TRACK A (Left Forearm Scratch Swab Analysis):

Swab analysis of the coat sleeve tear and forearm scratch revealed trace metal particles matching a craft cutter blade.

>>> TEST RESULT: 100% CLEAN & NON-TOXIC.

The scratch was a superficial wound sustained earlier today and played zero role in the victim's death. (Track A Eliminated).

2. TRACK B (Desk Tea Cup #5 Analysis):

Chemical testing confirmed lethal concentrations of botanical cyanide/almond toxin inside the tea cup.

>>> TEST RESULT: 100% UNTASTED & FULL.

Forensic medical records confirm the victim ceased consuming all caffeinated herbal teas 4 weeks prior on medical advice. Zero tea compounds or ingested toxins were detected in the digestive tract. (Track B Eliminated).

3. TRACK C (Right Palm & Lock Swab Analysis):

Swab analysis of the victim's right palm and the brass lock handle of Display Case RB-1147 confirmed heavy concentrations of an **organomercury-based fumigation compound**—a pale chartreuse archival preservation chemical.

>>> COMPOUND PROFILE: Lethally toxic through prolonged dermal absorption. Restricted hazardous material requiring **CATCH Certification**.

>>> CRITICAL LAB FINDING: This compound is **NATURALLY UV-FLUORESCENT!** Under 395nm UV blacklight, any contaminated liquid or surface will **GLOW VIBRANT NEON GREEN!**

Evidence Item 10: Curator's Secret Letter

ROUND 3 DROP • SIZED FOR 5" × 7" LASER-CUT
OVERLAY MASK

THE STARLIGHT ARCHIVES • FROM THE CURATOR'S DESK

To the members of the Starlight Circle,

As we gather tonight, I must remind you that the privileges granted inside the Starlight Archives are sacred. We built this circle on trust.

Unfortunately, recent audits reveal that someone manipulated **ITEM RB-1147** to mask their unlogged entry into the vault.

Tonight, I will prove who tampered with the brass **LOCK** before midnight. If you were hoping to cover your tracks, you **WAS** sorely mistaken. Everything that was **TAMPERED** with in the gallery archives will be brought to light.

— *The Curator*

OVERLAY THE XT00L P3 LASER-CUT MASK OVER THIS NOTE TO DECRYPT

Evidence Items 11 & 12: Duty Log & Trace Report

ROUND 3 DROP • FINAL FORENSIC CROSS-REFERENCE



EVIDENCE ITEM 11: CONSERVATION DUTY REGISTER

Target Item: Catalog Item RB-1147 (The Starlight Ledger) | **Location:** Vault Case #1

- **Primary Conservator for RB-1147 (Vault Cases): RAE LIN (Keeper of Keys)**
 - Certification: **CATCH** (Chemical Handling & Archival Toxicology)
 - Authorized Reagents: Full Chemical Kit (Jars A–E, including Jar E: Archival Fumigation Sealant)
 - Vault Case Authorization: **YES**
- **Secondary Conservator (Holding Area Items ONLY): CHARLOTTE (Rare Book Specialist)**
 - Certification: **CATCH** (Chemical Handling & Archival Toxicology)
 - Authorized Reagents: Full Chemical Kit (Jars A–E, including Jar E: Archival Fumigation Sealant)
 - Vault Case Authorization: **NO (Holding Area only)**
- **Prep Schedule Window:** 23:30 – 23:45 HRS (15-Minute Unmonitored Gap)



EVIDENCE ITEM 12: MASTER TOOLKIT & TRACE ANALYSIS

1. **Discarded Master Key #000:** Microscopic swab of Key #000 recovered from the courtyard hedges revealed brass dust particles matching the newly scraped lock tumblers of Display Case RB-1147!
2. **Chemical Kit UV Scan:** Jar E (Archival Fumigation Sealant) and Raelin's applicator cloth **GLOW NEON GREEN** under UV light, matching the organomercury compound swabbed from John's palm and the RB-1147 lock!
3. **Charlotte Alibi Verification:** Charlotte also holds CATCH certification, but she was verified at the intake desk with Georgia from 23:35 to 23:50 and does NOT hold Master Key #000!